



GROWTH

August 2026 Report

In the first 11 days of August, the oil market fell 5% - then jumped right back up by 5%.

The trigger wasn't a peace deal or a reopened shipping lane - it was a draft. Qatar floated a rough plan for reopening the Strait of Hormuz, and that piece of paper alone sent oil prices swinging around the world.

Those eleven days tell you everything about investing around this war.

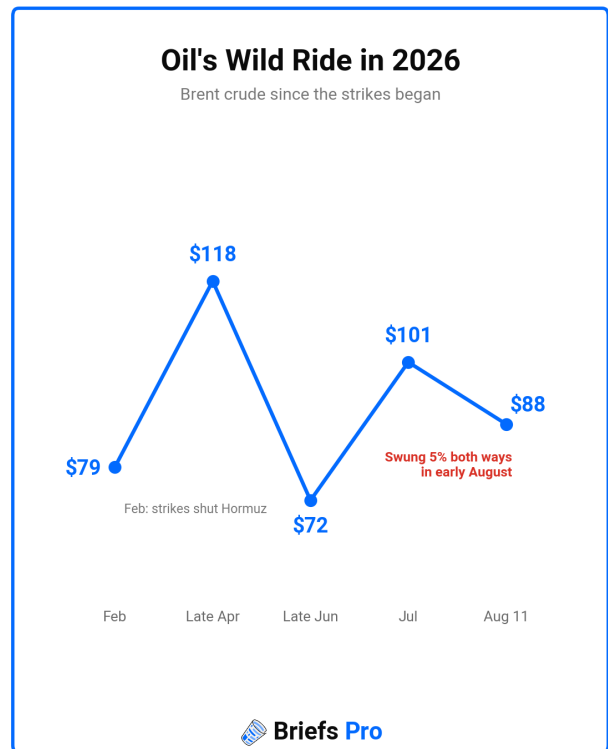
Quick catch-up: In late February, Israel and the U.S. began striking Iran's missile and nuclear sites. Within two days, the Strait of Hormuz - the narrow channel that carries about a third of the world's oil - was all but shut.

Since then, oil has been on a wild ride:

- Brent crude - the price tag on most of the world's oil - climbed out of the \$70s and hit \$118 by late April.
- It slid all the way back to \$72 by late June.
- It jumped back above \$100 in July.
- And now it sits near \$88 after those August swings.

Our team called a long war back in February, when most of Wall Street expected the fighting to wrap up within weeks. That call has held up so far - but knowing a war will drag on is very different from knowing when it ends.

We won't pretend to know that. And if one unsigned document can whip oil 5% in both directions, then any stock tied to this war is trading on headlines, not on business results.



Data via Briefs Research

The market has already priced this war in and priced it back out once. That turns every war-driven stock into a guessing game that resets with each headline.

This is where we've spotted a Broad Market Shift:

With no way to price how this war ends, growth money is rotating out of headline-driven trades and into companies whose customers couldn't care less about the conflict.

Think about what's actually driving growth in 2026. Millions of Latin Americans are bringing their shopping and banking online, while a handful of cloud giants pour billions into AI data centers.

Neither of those demand waves goes anywhere near the Persian Gulf. They formed before the war started, and they'll keep rolling long after it ends.

The bottom line: The fastest-growing businesses we track don't need this war to end - or to continue - to keep growing.

Below, we break down what's happening and the two stocks our analysts are adding to our Growth Portfolio.

ANALYST TAKE

Tickers we're tracking:

The marketplace: MELI

The chip designer: MRVL

THE MARKETPLACE

MercadoLibre (MELI) | Growth the War Can't Reach

What's happening? MercadoLibre runs Latin America's biggest online marketplace, plus one of its biggest digital payment networks - one company doing two jobs at once in Brazil, Mexico, and Argentina.

And it's growing fast on both fronts. First-quarter revenue jumped 49% from a year earlier, and Wall Street was looking for about \$9.77 billion in second-quarter revenue - roughly 44% growth.

That second-quarter report just landed this week. A strong print backs up everything below, so investors may want to check those fresh numbers first.

So why does an online shopping stock belong in a war report? Because its protection is built into the map.



Data via Briefs Terminal

MELI's customers are shoppers in Brazil and Mexico bringing more of their lives online - demand the war simply can't reach, no matter which way the strait swings.

Our growth engine gives the stock an A-, the top mark of any non-megacap name we track, because it's riding two demand waves at once:

- More Latin Americans shopping online every year.
- More of them banking and paying digitally, too.

A megacap is one of the trillion-dollar giants at the very top of the market - so MELI is the best scorer of everything below that tier.

MELI isn't cheap. It trades at about 43 times forward earnings, against roughly 20 for the S&P 500 - you're paying up for all of that growth.

Entry range: Our analysts peg the buy zone at \$1,700 to \$1,900 per share - shares are sitting near the top of that at \$1,828.

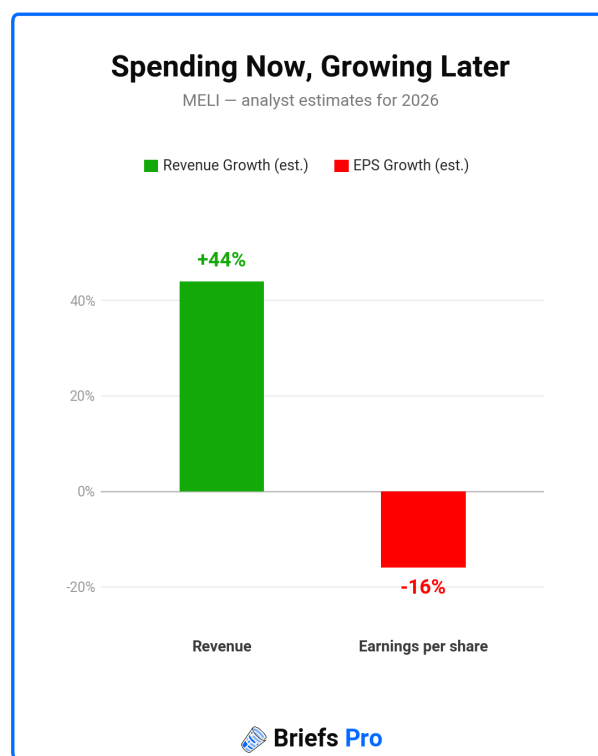
There's a catch worth knowing, too. MELI is pouring cash into warehouses, delivery, and its lending arm right now, and that spending squeezes profits in the short run.

Analysts see its earnings per share falling about 16% this year even while revenue climbs around 44%. In short, the company is trading today's profit for tomorrow's size.

Swings in Latin American money also come standard with this stock. Currencies in Brazil and Argentina can lose value fast, which can dent MELI's reported results even when the business itself is healthy.

That's why our analysts split this buy in two: half before this week's report, and half once the fresh numbers settle.

Exit Trigger: If revenue growth falls out of the 40% range and keeps sliding, or losses in its lending business start stacking up, the spend-now-grow-later trade breaks down - and investors may want to step back.



Data via Briefs Research

THE CHIP DESIGNER

Marvell Technology (MRVL) | Riding the AI Spending Wave

Marvell is the other half of this pair, and it rides a spending wave even a war hasn't slowed: AI.

Marvell designs custom chips, plus the hardware that links those chips together, for hyperscalers - the handful of giant cloud players racing to put up AI data centers.

When a cloud giant wants its own chip instead of a standard one off the shelf, Marvell is one of the few companies it can hire to create it.

The scoreboard from its latest fiscal year:

- Revenue climbed 42%, reaching \$8.2 billion.
- Data center work now makes up three-quarters of the whole business, after growing 46% to more than \$6 billion.
- Its custom chip line reached \$1.5 billion - more than twice its old size.
- The company has named 18 custom-chip projects with its customers, and many of those designs are already shipping in volume.



Data via Briefs Terminal

Where's the war protection here? AI budgets get set in the boardrooms of a few giant cloud companies, and nothing about this conflict changes what they plan to spend.

Our growth engine gives Marvell an A- as well, with the best mark in its tier for turning demand into actual revenue.

At about \$217 per share, the stock works if two things stay true: cloud giants keep wanting their own custom chips, and they keep picking Marvell to design them.

The speed bump: growth is cooling off a red-hot pace. In the latest quarter, our team clocks revenue growth at about 28% from a year ago - down from the 42% pace of the full fiscal year.

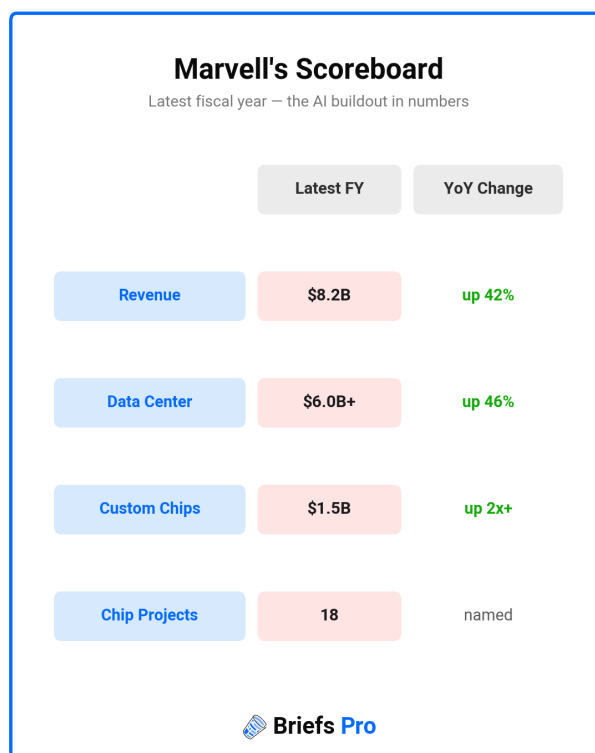
A couple more things worth knowing:

- A small group of very large customers drives most of the business.
- The stock trades with the AI mood - when investors sour on AI, Marvell usually feels it first.

Its late-August earnings report is the next big test, which is why our analysts split this buy too: half now, half after that report.

Entry range: \$200 to \$230 per share - the stock trades inside that zone today.

Exit Trigger: If data center growth keeps slowing quarter after quarter, or a major cloud customer walks, the engine behind this stock stalls and investor returns could follow.



Data via Marvell Company Filings

THREE SCENARIOS

The Road Ahead

Nobody can call how this war ends - that's the whole point of this report. What we can do is sketch the three most likely paths over the next twelve months, with our team's odds on each.

The most likely path (around 45% odds): The Qatari-drafted deal, or something close to it, sticks. The strait reopens with naval escorts, oil drifts back into the \$70s, and shipping slowly returns to normal.

For these two stocks, almost nothing changes - their customers never needed the strait open in the first place.

The standoff path (around 35% odds): The draft dies, the strait stays shut or keeps flaring up into 2027, and oil swings between \$90 and \$110 on every headline.

Pricier fuel pinches shoppers a little, which is a mild drag on growth stocks - but the shopping and AI demand behind these two keeps rolling.

The escalation path (around 20% odds): Strikes resume and spread, oil breaks above \$110, and stock markets sell off across the board.

We'll be straight with you: MELI and Marvell would fall with the market in that world. Their businesses, though, would keep compounding - growing on top of growth - right through it.

These odds are our team's research-backed estimates, but they're still estimates, not promises.

The Road Ahead: Three Scenarios

Team estimates for the next twelve months

45% Managed Reopening

The Qatari draft sticks, the strait reopens with escorts, and oil drifts back to the \$70s.

35% The Standoff

The draft dies and the strait stays shut into 2027. Oil swings \$90-\$110 on every headline.

20% Escalation

Strikes spread, oil breaks \$110, and markets sell off - these two fall, but keep compounding.

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RISKS WE'RE WATCHING

How This Shift Could Change

Both stocks are priced for high growth, so anything that dents that growth hurts - war or no war.

- An AI spending pause would squeeze Marvell hard.
- A Latin American recession would do the same to MELI.

These are also the two names here with the farthest to fall if the whole market sells off, because growth stocks swing hard in both directions.

Timing matters right now as well, with MELI's report just out and Marvell's landing in late August - either report could move its stock sharply on its own.

Lastly, these picks dodge one storm: the Iran war. A U.S. recession, an AI winter, or a rate shock would each be a different kind of problem - and this pair isn't shielded from those.

THE BOTTOM LINE

The Takeaway

One unsigned draft sent the oil market swinging 5% both ways this month. That's the game investors sign up for when they bet on this war's ending.

MELI and Marvell let growth investors skip that game. One gets paid when Latin America shops and banks online, and the other gets paid when cloud giants build AI data centers - and neither depends on a strait half a world away.

The war will end whenever it ends. These two businesses aren't waiting on it - and for growth investors, MELI and MRVL may be potential opportunities worth keeping an eye on.



- Briefs Finance Team

*The Briefs Finance Team often invests in the same stocks and assets we cover.

Why? Because we believe in practicing what we preach (and preaching what we practice).

But keep in mind: We're not financial advisors. Everything we provide is for education. You've got to do your own due diligence and think about what makes sense for your own financial situation. Investing has risks.

You are never guaranteed to make money when you invest, you might even lose money. If you're looking for personalized financial advice, we highly recommend speaking with a licensed financial advisor.

Our mission? It's simple - to help you be better with money.

Included interviews have been edited for length and clarity.